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Editor's Note

Dear Reader,

It was a hard road coming. The second semester, always a whirlwind of different activities, has been dotted with intense debates about student democracy. Speeches have been made, treatises written; Facebook and KMLA Online have been bursting with calls for change. Hopefully, our ideas will remain to affect necessary transformations within school.

The theme of this issue is freedom at KMLA, a timely topic. As with any fledgling institution, KMLA is still struggling to answer certain fundamental questions. One of the more crucial questions deal with student freedom. What does student freedom mean? How should it be exercised? How should we interpret the status quo? What are its limitations?

My firm philosophy, as a leader of press in a small society, is that press should think. Creative thinking, coupled with depth, creates power—the power to consolidate people and to craft change. I want us to be writers that constantly practice transforming the minds of others. I hope our efforts are met with support but also, more importantly, constructive criticism and the addition of different perspectives and ideas. Your interest is integral to making the empowerment of *Minjok Herald* worthwhile.

As you flip through this issue with *honjeong* bread on your right and the milk flanking your left, I hope something catches your eye. I hope that something gets you thinking beyond the usual clichés and the defeatist philosophy. I hope you talk about whatever you have with as many people around you. And when you can, I hope you act upon that idea.

But most importantly, enjoy the read. Laugh at happy memories, cry at sad ones. Be angered when appropriate, but try to be proud whenever you can. Remember, this is history in the making. Thank you.

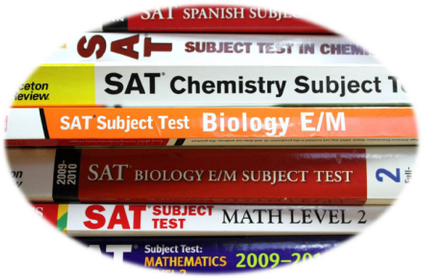
Park So-Hyeon
Editor-in-Chief

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A Memorable Night for KMLAians

All the King's Men Performs at KMLA



All the King's Men wrap up their performance at KMLA

All the King's Men, a famous a cappella group comprising students from King's College in England, came to Korean Minjok Leadership Academy on the 29th of August and held a brilliant performance that astounded all KMLAians.

All the King's Men is a living success. Its immediate achievement of acclaims, a reception contrary to initial expectations, brought it attention in the collegiate a cappella scene. Its popularity gradually expanded to the general public. "Winning third place at the ICCA (International Championship of Collegiate A Cappella), and thus becoming officially recognized as the third best collegiate a cappella group in the world was an achievement that thrilled all of us," said Lee Eun-Song, a Korean member of the group.

When asked about the key elements to such acclaim, Mr. Lee cited three factors: passion, entertainment, and team spirit. He said, "Anybody who is willing to share his or her passion, team spirit, and talent is always welcome. " He also added that "The sole purpose of our group is to entertain all those who see our performance, and make sure that both the audience and we have the best time possible together." Mr. Lee along with the rest of the group takes pride in the fact that they self-arrange all their music. Creativity is integral to their performance.

"My friends and I enjoyed not only the music itself, but also the smiles on the faces of the singers and their passionate performance as well," said 18th waver Lim Yoon-Sung, one of the students who attended the performance. He added, "Most of the performances were creative and fresh to our ears. We had never heard this kind of music before."

The pure enthusiasm arising from the group's team spirit to entertain their audience, coupled with the positive reactions from the KMLAians, made for a refreshing performance. The performance was a memorable way to mark the commencement of the semester.

Cho Nam-Eek
Junior Writer, 18th wave

Student Interaction Needed in KMLA-KSA Exchange



KMLA's softball team takes the trophy for this year.

On Saturday, September 14th, the third sports competition between Korean Minjok Leadership Academy and Korean Science Academy (KSA) was held at Korean Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST). The whole of the 18th wave and a few 17th wavers participated in this event. Despite the terrible weather, competitors showed their fervent efforts. Ardent cheers from students of each school heated up the atmosphere all the more.

This year, KMLA claimed the ultimate trophy, winning both the soccer and softball games. Despite the defeat in basketball, KMLA came out victorious with a comfortable 2-0 win in soccer and a 20-9 win in softball.

In reality, however, this event was a source of intense controversy even before it took place. For one, the issue of word choice on the cheering banners of KSA raised voices of disapproval among KMLAians. Phrases such as "We'll give you half a potato if you will bring us some chocolate milk and bread," and" Is WiFi available at Hoengseong?" were regarded with feelings of resentment by KMLAians. Many thought it a direct insult against KMLA and against Hoengseong as well. 17th waver Lee Na-Ra expressed her displeasure for the banners via Facebook by posting that "As a student of KMLA and as a person who grew up in Gangwon-do, I felt very uncomfortable with the words that the KSA students so explicitly displayed through their cheering banners."

Furthermore, many KMLAians questioned whether the competition's genuine goal of promoting friendship between the two schools was ever achieved. 18th waver Cho Woo-Hyun, a participant in the event, said, "Even though this competition was for the sake of encouraging friendship and communication between the two schools, students from our school never got the opportunity to talk to the students from KSA. I sincerely hope the school will change things up a bit so that from next year, students will actually have the chance to make new friends and accomplish the true goal of an exchange sports competition."

As with any exchange program between two or more schools, the goal of the KSA sports competition should be to promote friendship and communication between KMLA and KSA. Its purpose or result should not solely be consolidation within the student body at the expense of the other school. During next year's KSA sports competition, many KMLAians hope no school will be offended by deprecatory remarks; they also hope students of both schools have a wonderful and meaningful time with new people.

Lee Seung-Jun
Junior Writer, 18th wave

The Library Initiative Takes Root in KMLA

A Leading Action to Meet the Needs of KMLAians

The Library Initiative, a project seeking to increase the number of foreign books in the library, has started taking root this semester. "There are plenty of cultured books in our library," says 17th waver Sung Ho-Kyung, "but should we require depth, we are stumped." Many KMLAians feel that the supply of foreign books in the library is insufficient for extensive research. According to the librarian Mr. Kim Dong-Myeong and the school library website, only 28% of the books in the library and 27% of books purchased last year are foreign publications.

The twenty people who participate submit a list of foreign books to the library, to request its purchase every month. Instead of relying on voluntary submissions, the library can now receive a steady stream of requests and allocate the budget accordingly. Sung, a participant, stated, "Everything kicked off from Park, who wrote an editorial article about the flaws of our library in *Minjok Herald* on the October of 2012. She independently composed a list of books the library lacks last winter, and requested their purchase. What the Library Initiative is pursuing is maintaining both variety and depth in the books we newly order while prioritizing quantity. The current plan is to categorize books of our interests in accordance with the decimal classification, and then to compile a list of volumes to request the school to order." Now what could the authorities do for this project? "My role is to encourage Park to do her work, advise her accordingly to the school's system so that her requests can be realized, and check whether the books are adequate for the library, the school, and the budget," says Mr. Kim.



Regarding the project, Mr. Kim says, "It is great that students are volunteering for our school," while Park stated, "I am planning to publicize this project and recruit more people. The librarian suggests that I turn this into some club to make this a tradition to pass down". If one is interested, one could contact Park and join in, or visit the school library website and order books one requires.

Roh Hye-Sung
Junior Writer, 18th wave

On Teaching Histroy, Learning Foreign Languages, and Unconventional Leadership

Visitors from Kyung Hee, Seoul National, and Harvard Talk to KMLA

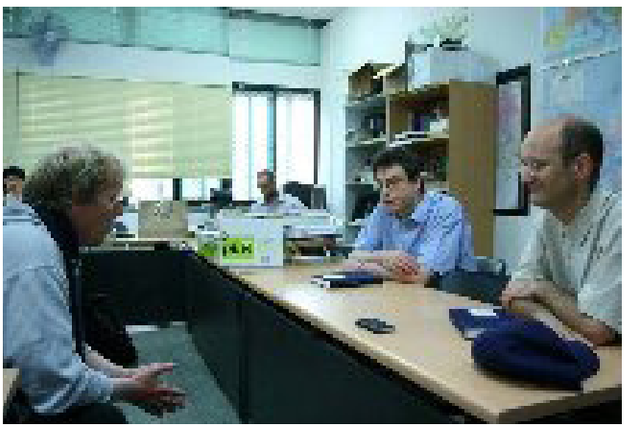
On the 21st of July, while the rest of the student body was on vacation, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy had the privilege to receive very special guests from outside and abroad. Professor Michael Puett of Harvard, Professor Emanuel Pastreich of Kyung Hee University, and Mr. Arthur Michalak of Seoul National University came to visit Mr. Alexander Ganse, our history teacher, in his cozy office. Mr. Ganse had been requested to share his teaching methods with the visitors; Mr. Art Michalak, who teaches in the biannual schoolwide camp, Global Leadership Program for Students, kindly made this meeting possible. Other than two reporters for the *Minjok Herald*, many students from Mr. Ganse's class were present. Lee Chung-Hyun, Lee Eun-Ji, Lee Hye-Jin, and Yoo Seung-In were the seniors; Jang Su-A, Kim Min-Gyu, and Choo Bum-Jun were the juniors.

Our conversation began with Mr. Ganse, who explained his method of teaching and educational philosophy to the guests. He expressed his regret at a government policy which forced him to give written exams twice a semester; the teachers all agreed history was clearly not about memorizing dates or names. Mr. Ganse then explained that his focus was in teaching students how to effectively separate information, the relevant from the irrelevant, and the credible from the dubious. Holding up a book called Big History, he said "I would make the students find the errors in this book," as an example of his teaching methods. He also recounted the Raffles Institute visit during last summer. He recollected how the Singaporean students had actively participated in class, giving comments to student presentations.

Students had the opportunity to introduce themselves and their future plans to the professors. Mr. Ganse explained how each student moved a step further in realizing his or her potential in his classes. Research topics like the impact of the bicycle on the liberalization of women and the comparative study on the development of archery as weaponry were discussed.

As this part of conversation drew to a close, *Minjok Herald* had the opportunity to ask questions to our visitors. The following is a faithful account of our interviews.

Minjok Herald: *Professor Puett, could you explain to us about your teachings at Harvard?*
Professor Michael Puett: Well, I teach Chinese history at Harvard. More specifically, I center around ancient Chinese philosophy. My classes start by using translated material. With more advanced courses, I would use primary sources, since translations always have limits. We would cover a very wide range of topics, dating even up to contemporary issues. Current East Asian diplomatic tensions can be thought of in terms of the philosophies prevalent in China from thousands of years ago.



Clockwise from left: Mr. Ganse, Mr. Puett, and Mr. Michalak begin their talk on the value of critical thinking.

MH: *As a fellow teacher, what do you find as most remarkable in Mr. Ganse's teaching methods?*
Prof. Puett: Mr. Ganse's extraordinary vision, undoubtedly. He executes education on critical thinking most perfectly. As Mr. Ganse pointed out, learning is not memorizing the discovery of others. It is a process that continues throughout your lifetime. Because it is such a long process, it is imperative you learn how to interpret the information around you. Saying critical thinking is for people in a much later stage of learning is wrong. Facts can always be learned later.

MH: *Is there any difference or similarity between Mr. Ganse's classes and yours?*
Prof. Puett: I am sure the philosophy is much the same. I just lack the ability to implement them as well as Mr. Ganse does.

MH: *How would you describe your classes at Harvard? How do you promote critical thinking?*
Prof. Puett: I want students to be able to pick up something and immediately sense what the writer is trying to argue and why he is arguing from that position. How is the author using the information in the piece to support his or her argument? This kind of skill is essential for understanding any and every kind of writing.

MH: *In your opinion, professor, how can Harvard students grow through your course?*
Prof. Puett: Hopefully, they learn how to learn critically (smiles). This is a constructive world. We have grown, albeit slowly, in this world, changing things. Everything around you has the possibility of changing. You should always think about the world critically before you start accepting things. I cannot emphasize the importance of critical thinking enough. Many students undoubtedly benefit from such skills in university-level education. Such skills should be promoted because these skills are crucial to living as human beings. Which is why I think everyone should get Mr. Ganse's kind of training.

MH: *Professor Pastreich, you told us that you majored in classical Chinese, yet you are deeply involved in environmental issues: how exactly did you make that transition?*
Professor Emanuel Pastreich: I would not say that I am an expert in that field, but the environment simply became an increasingly important issue to me. Thus I have written extensively about it, particularly on the question of international collaboration. I also work with an organization called Future Forest to bring youth from China and Korea together to plant trees in China and Mongolia to prevent desertification.

MH: *Speaking of youth, we also heard that you were very interested in youth leadership. Why do you think youth leadership is important and what should the roles of the youth be?*
Prof. Pastreich: I may know more than you do in some respects, but I am not assuming myself to be more of a leader than you. The youth is the greatest priority, and I feel that elite people who talk about things like climate change and say, "I will be dead by then anyway," are being very irresponsible. Nothing could be more important, as long as I live, than to see what I can do to help people in the next generation and to work with them. We are living in an age of superannuated societies. Old people have very different priorities compared to young people, so a certain sclerosis or inflexibility arises when only the elders run societies. Therefore, young people have to become leaders and start coming up with new ideas about what the world should be. However, one cannot actually teach leadership; one c-

an induce it, but one cannot teach it.

MH: *Then, in your opinion, what is the best way to induce leadership in students?*
Prof. Pastreich: Well, you could raise problems for discussions. For example, here in KMLA the emphasis is on ethnic identity, yet you are only allowed to use English. What does that mean? What is the intention of this policy? When such problems are introduced, you are led to see the world in a different way as you try to understand how separate things work together.

MH: *This next question goes to both of you: what do you, with your great expertise and wide range of interests, suggest we do if we become interested in a certain subject without any logical reason?*
Prof. Puett: If something that is not a part of where you think you are going simply seems exciting, although you cannot really put why you like it into words, just go for it. It could truly end up changing your life. I myself changed my field completely from European history to Chinese history; ecological concerns have no direct relevance to Chinese history. This has continued throughout my life, and all of the things I do I began simply by pursuing things that seemed important or exciting to me even if I could not, at the time, explain why they did.
Prof. Pastreich: I can relate to that: when I started college, I was taking French literature, and I did not really enjoy it that much. So I took a class in Chinese literature and translation, and the class was… okay. It was not really exciting, but I became extremely interested in Chinese characters, and started learning them on my own… and that was the beginning.
Prof. Puett: You are currently in high school, but soon you will be in college, where there is a huge amount of choice regarding courses. When that time comes, you will, I am sorry to say, have advisors that will say, "You need to that this set of courses to get into where you decided your career to be." Do not listen to them. Choose courses that look exciting, even for reasons that seem to make no sense. There's no loss if you take a class for fun but not pursue it. But it also could change your life: it has for me.
Prof. Pastreich: There are some fundamental principles—contradictions and consistency, correlation and causality—that are true for all subjects. Regardless of your starting point, you will learn these. For example, I studied Chinese first and Korean much later. But you can only do that if you learn how to learn languages: that is, learning the process by which you train yourself. For me, that meant things like speaking only the language, and not reading English. The most important thing in learning foreign languages is to always force yourself up. If there is some impossible class, sign up for it. You will have a hard time, especially at the beginning, but you will catch up. There are limits, but in general, if people expect something of you, you will rise to meet that expectation. This is why I feel that the best way to teach is not to say, "I want you to do this for the test," but "I want you to talk to me as if you were another professor." If students feel this—it is a little bit of attention, right?—they will, in many cases, rise to that level.
Prof. Puett: Of course, if I ask students to rise to my level, that is pretty low standard, but if you have to rise to Emanuel's level, that would be tough. (Laughter)
Prof. Pastreich: He is a remarkable teacher: Michael is a much more relaxed person than I am.
Mr. Michalak: I can tell, because you buttoned your top buttons (laughter).

MH: *Thank you, I think that is more or less it. Do you have anything in general to tell us… to the youth or to KMLAians?*
Prof. Puett: Well, I would say one of the biggest dangers is the fear that one cannot do something. Now, as Emanuel said, one may not be able to learn 500,000 languages, but that limit is so far beyond what we ever tend to expect of ourselves. I think that the key lesson in life is that you can do anything if you put what you want to do in practice, and once you learn that at a young age, you will go far beyond anything you would ever have dreamed of. So it is incredibly exciting to be here, to see that the lives you can lead, and now certainly will be able to lead will be just inspiring. (To Professor Pastreich) Your turn.
Prof. Pastreich: I will keep it short. One of your key words is leadership, and I think it is very important to think about what this term really means. There is a danger hat you will think of it as an obsolete, meaningless word, but it is a very important term. We have to start by remembering that true leadership does not mean being a CEO or a president. We also should not confuse it with the leadership we see on TV: in most cases, that is not leadership at all, but merely an adherence to conventions. I would say some of the greatest leaders in history were people whose names we do not even remember, people who took steps to change habits and culture, and that all of us are very capable of being true leaders in that respect.

Professor Michael Puett is the Walter C. Klein Professor of Chinese History in the Department of East Asian Languages and Civilizations at Harvard. He came to South Korea on invitation by Kyung Hee University.

Professor Emanuel Pastreich is an associate professor at Kyung Hee Universiy and a director of The Asia Institute in Seoul. He also has a Korean name: Lee Man-Yeol.

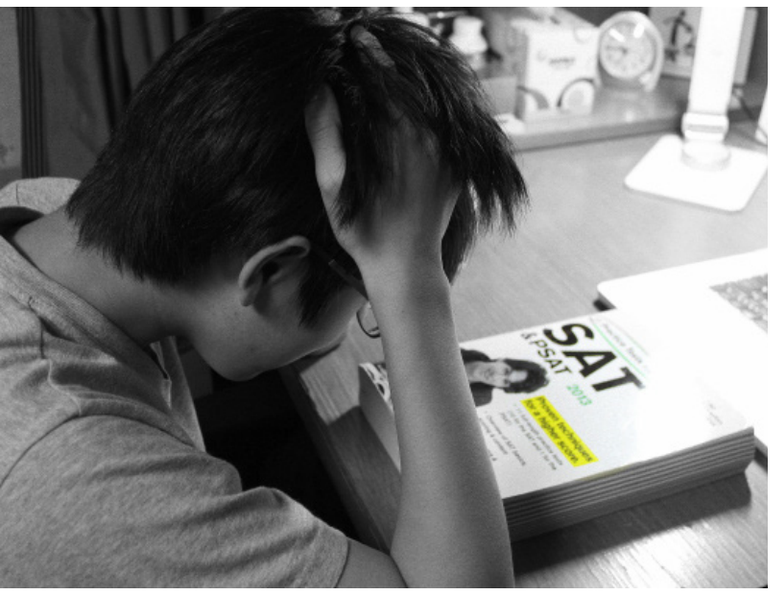
Lee Jin-Gyu, Park So-Hyeon
Staff Writer, 17th Wave



Clockwise from top left: Lee Jin-Gyu, Mr. Puett, Mr. Michalak, Mr. Ganse, Lee Eun-Ji, Lee Chung-Hyun, and Lee Hye-Jin, participants in the discussion take a group photo. The professors look quite at home with the helmets.

Cheating Scandals in the SAT Exasperate KMLAians

What Happened After the Scandals





The SAT (Scholastic Aptitude Test) is a standardized test considered an integral factor for admission into colleges abroad. On January, a cheating scandal set alight a series of unpredictable test cancellations that have caused serious anxiety among students. Another cheating scandal during the 2013 October SAT led to the expansion of ongoing investigations and rising blame toward academies involved in illicit activities. The Prosecution Service added two more SAT academies to its investigation targets, officially notifying that another cheating scandal happened in the October SAT. Investigations and arrests are ongoing. How are KMLAians reacting? 18th waver Kim Kang-San stated, "I cannot understand why those academies are continuously cheating. It is even more unbelievable that there are some parents who ask for previous SAT questions in academies."

This problem is not new. 16th wavers in KMLA had been incensed by SAT cancellations as the May and June SATs were the last tests before the early application. 16th waver Kim Hong-Soon, who took the SAT US History Subject Test in Japan because he was nervous about additional cancellations, expressed his displeasure. He said, "Crooked academies cost me time and money, annulled the efforts of innocent students, and potentially damaged the chances of every Korean student preparing for foreign colleges." Not only 16th wavers in the international field, but also 17th wavers who were planning to take the SAT Biology Subject Test in June experienced difficulties. 17th waver Lee Gi-Na, one of the students whose biology test was cancelled, stated, "I thought I would not need to take any biology exams after June. To my disappointment, I had to continue preparing until October."

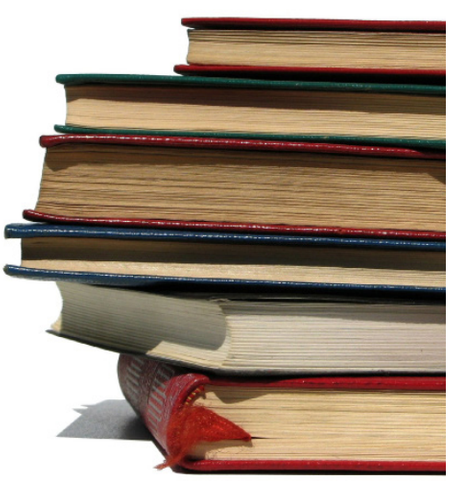
The influence of the SAT cancellations reached even the 18th wavers. In fact, all of the five 18th wavers who took their first SAT I on October 5th admitted that they felt worried and nervous about another cancellation. 18th waver Jeong Hyun-Ji, who took the SAT I for the first time in October showed her discontent. "Worldwide cheatings by SAT academies in the October SAT have ruined the score curve. Before the test, I was afraid another scandal would happen. The fear turned real."

Some KMLAians say that the College Board and the ETS should be held accountable for the way they are handling these matters. 16th waver Kim Hong-Soon pointed to the problem of late notification, saying, "Many 12th graders, including I, were nervous that the College Board would cancel the exam suddenly and make late announcements like it did in May." The way the tests are produced is also a problem. 18th waver Roh Hye-Sung said, "Even my friends in India have already solved the questions before the examination. Cheating is definitely the wrong of academies. However, the College Board is partly responsible for the scandal happening again in October. They seem to do nothing to prevent these incidents. They did not even offer new questions on the October SAT."

Due to the scandal, the ACT (American College Testing) is gaining popularity among KMLAians as an alternative to the SAT. Mrs. Son Eun-Ju, current counselor to the freshmen International Field, explained the ACT was another standardized examination accepted as an equivalent to the SAT. 18th waver Jeon Hyun-Su, who took his first SAT I last October, said, "I am currently thinking of taking the ACT in the future. The SAT is not safe from scandals anymore." The ACT, in fact, is a well-known alternative to the SAT. For one, it costs less; moreover, the number of tests taken is not recorded. One 17th waver told *Minjok Herald* that "I registered for the ACT as soon as I heard about the SAT scandals. Taking the SAT is not a good option for me anymore. A high score would only be held suspect; it would not be a plus to my college applications."

Questions of cheating by Korean academies were sporadically brought up before, but cancellations of the May and June SATs in all of Korea indicates the gravity of the current situation. Due to the irresponsible behavior of some test takers and the late notification by the College Board, many KMLAians are exasperated more than ever.

Kim Ye-Seul
Junior Writer, 18th wave



Outdoor Regulations Under Fire

Opinions Regarding Stricter Policies for Going Out on Weekends Vary



Starting from this semester, the school decided to prohibit students from going out on every first, third, and fifth weekend. Moreover, the school recently set a time limit on going to Hoengseong Service Station to two hours in the afternoon. After the decision of the school, the 15th Executive Council had uploaded a post on KMLA Forum (No. 96671) to gather opinions for alternative activities on every first, third, and fifth weekend. After a semester-long implementation, where does the policy stand now?

The main purpose of the new policy is to let students use their time more autonomously. Students can be active during the weekend with club activities, Minjok Peer Tutoring (MPT), and other activities that they could not take part in during the weekdays due to lack of time. Others can self-study or participate in various extracurricular activities led by teachers. Furthermore, the school is also trying to restrain KMLAians from attending private academies. According to Dr. Han Man-Wi, the Deputy Headmaster for Educational Planning, "What is more important for students is to develop the ability to manage their time effectively. Contemplating their respective majors, futures, and daily lives is worthier than taking classes at private academies just for the sake of good scores."

As with any major change, this policy was met with voices of both support and concern. 16th waver Kim Zi-On agreed with the new policy because he believed that it fits with the school's ideology—cultivating future global leaders through innovative education. Kim thought that KMLAians would have more time to engage in autonomous and school-oriented activities should this policy be enforced. 16th waver Kim Sang-Hyun and 17th waver Kil San were more circumspect. They both expressed their views that "the school infringes upon personal liberties" by forbidding students from going out. A bigger problem was that the school was not providing any viable alternatives. To resolve this, Kim suggested the school should provide preparation courses for Olympiads or other competitions by inviting professionals from the outside.

After an entire semester living with this policy, many KMLAians are inclined to complain. On KMLA Forum, some 17th wavers pointed out many students continue attending academies in the second and the fourth weekends, frequenty making excuses to go out on the forbidden weekends as well (Post No. 98805). More importantly, this intrusion upon "private liberties" seems to thwart the students' ability to "manage their time effectively." 17th wave Kim Hyun-yeon feels the school's purpose of encouraging students to engage in club and extracurricular activities is hindered by the new policy. "Students need to hand in official absence application forms for club activities and other official extracurricular activities. The process itself is overburdening. For many students, activities outside of school is equally important as well." Though the end of the semester is drawing near, students find themselves still asking for Olympiad preparation courses or after-school classes that can replace private academies. The school has yet to make an effective move on this request.

Positive voices can still be heard as well. Several students claimed that they could have more chance to participate in extracurricular activities as they have more time to gather in the weekends. Certainly, the positive impact the school foresaw are being realized as well.

Though the new policy was established to encourage students to participate in club activities, many think it rather causes more inconvenience and problems to students. For many KMLA students, activities outside the school is very important. The school, however, thinks this policy is integral to making students more independent. Hopefully, more communication between the school and students in resolving this issue will bear fruit in a constructive solution.

Kim Ri-Hyun
Staff Writer, 17th wave

Major Changes in Curriculum for Next Freshmen

Mandatory Computer Classes Along with Emphasis on Arts and Athletics Planned

Starting from the next semester, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy will implement some major changes regarding the curriculum for the 19th wave, who will enter the school next March. According to Mr. Park Yong-Sung, Manager of the Office of Curriculum Management, computer classes will become mandatory for all 10th graders, while a few changes will be made on the music and physical education curricula for the freshmen as well.

"The greatest change is undoubtedly the necessitation of computer classes," explained Mr. Park. He stated that in the past years, the school emphasized its strengths in the natural sciences through computer classes. This concentration was not difficult as computer sciences was taught as a part of the Technology and Home Economics curriculum, a course the Ministry of Education deemed worth requiring.

"But when the Ministry of Education no longer made these courses necessary a few years ago, taking computer classes became optional. KMLAians now had to choose between computer classes and foreign language classes. Many preferred to take the foreign language classes. As such, the number of students who took computer classes decreased significantly," said Mr. Park. "And now, the school feels that it should revive computer classes to strengthen its emphasis on the natural sciences." As 19th wavers will have two hours of computer class every week, the requirement to take H+IR classes will be lifted from them, as a compensatory measure for their additional burden.

Along with the imposition of computer classes, some major changes are planned for the 19th wavers in their music curriculum. Instead of choosing between music and art classes, 19th wavers will now have to take both. "The school believes that KMLAians should be provided with a broader range of experience in the arts," said Mr. Park. From next year, freshmen will have one hour for each of music and art per week and be able to choose between calligraphy and computer graphics for their art classes.

Amendments in the physical education curriculum are planned as well for the new freshmen, as half of the 19th wavers will be required to take archery while the other half will be required to take golf. "The school feels this modification is necessary as these two fields of sports, especially archery, are essential to fostering the Korean national spirit within the students. This change was planned before it reached even the teachers," explained Mr. Park.

17th waver Lee Seok-Hwa was rather skeptical about this curriculum change.



"I feel that one of the merits of the KMLA education is the amount of freedom we have when registering for courses. I am not fully convinced it is right for the school to deprive KMLAians of such freedoms merely for the sake of new computer classes." 17th waver Choo Bum-Jun, who also heard about this issue, also expressed his disapproval. "It is great that the school is trying to offer a diversity of courses, but in the case of the art and music curricula, an hour for each class seems insufficient; students will be forced to remain at a superficial level for each subject."

No student or teacher is absolutely certain about the changes that these modifications in the curriculum will bring to the school. As with all other new systems, this altered curriculum will be criticized along the way and will have to be improved many times for it to contribute to the ideal education that students have always longed for.

Kim Byeong-Yun
Staff Writer, 17th wave

How KMLA Graduates Burn Their Passions

Interview with 14th waver Kim Min-Ju

Students of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy have the chance to make videos on many occasions. For instance, last semester, the 11th graders made User Created Contents (UCCs) for their Korean History class, executed with superb skill, resulting in many high-quality videos. However, for some students, the excitement of making videos does not end with graduation. A while ago, some KMLA alumni got together to make a video on a larger scale: a short movie called *Ji-Geum*! Here is an interview with the director of this project, Kim Min-Ju, a 14th waver.

Minjok Herald: *Can you give us a brief introduction about the film?*
Kim Min-Ju: The short film I directed this summer is called All You Can Now, *Ji-Geum* in Korean. There are two main characters, Mirae, who is in her early twenties, struggling to succeed as a filmmaker, and her mother Younhee, who is in her late forties, feeling stuck in her banal life. All You Can Now is a film of a film; Mirae makes a film where her mother is the main character. It attempts to convey what it takes to find happiness in life.

MH: *How did you get interested in films?*
Kim: I started to picture myself in the film industry when I was in my second year at KMLA. Film was always there for me when I faced life's challenges as a teenager. These films were not answers to my questions, but companions walking me through the questions.

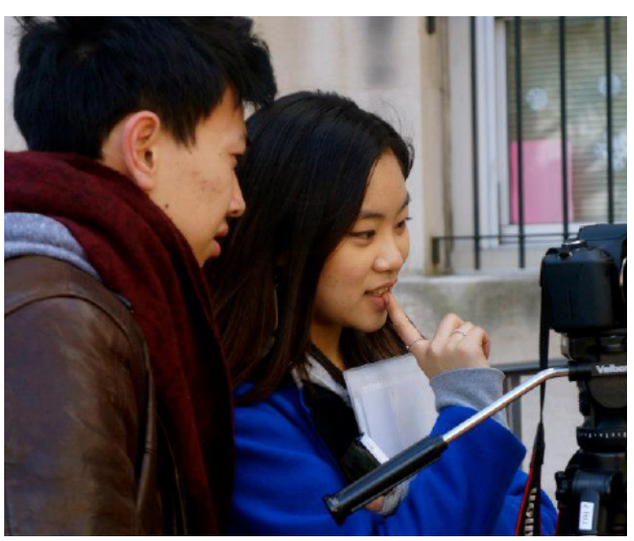
MH: *If you could give us some examples?*
Kim: When I started to realize the great difficulties of living as a woman, I watched *Poetry* and *Volver*. When I began to question what love is, I watched *Blue Valentine* and *Closer*. When happiness, a concept once so vivid and clear to me, seemed to fade, I watched *Happy-Go-Lucky*.

MH: *What is it about filmmaking that makes you want to do it?*
Kim: Life is very, very complicated, partly because it is mine and I cannot see it clearly and objectively from my point of view, and partly because relationships, emotions and life are all complicated in nature. For me, seeing a film is taking a piece from this intricate world of life, looking into it, and trying to reach an understanding. In that sense, filmmaking is a truly magical process, creating a piece of life. I believe that directing a film involves building another reality and bringing attention to what we often neglect to see in the real world.

MH: *We have heard that many other students from KMLA are participating in the movie. Who are they and what are their roles?*
Kim: Except for a person helping with the cinematography, all of the members are KMLA alumni. Personally, I feel limited in terms of the resources that I have for filmmaking, especially in Korea since I go to a school in the U.S. However, I feel very blessed to have all of my friends from KMLA willing to help, stepping out of their comfort zones for this project. Park Hyun (14th wave) translated the script from English to Korean. Claire Yi (14th) is the assistant director, Lee Hee-Yoon (14th), producer, Bae Gwang-Bin (14th), cinematographer, Do Ha-Young (13th), script supervisor, and Lee Hyo-Young (14th), continuity supervisor, also in charge of the clapperboard. Han Min-Jung (14th) and Son Bo-Kyung (14th) are in charge of casting and location, Jung Youn-Kyung (14th), storyboard, Aum Ji-Won (13th) and Youn Seo-Ho (14th), sound, Kim Min-Kyung (14th) and Byun Jin-Sil (14th), costume and prop, and Jung Ha-Byeol (14th), lighting.

Interaction between KMLA's graduates are far-reaching, even after graduation. Obviously, KMLA alumni are not forgetting what KMLA is all about: living hard, yet not losing grasp of the passion that lies in their hearts.

Lee Chang-Hun
Staff Writer, 17th wave



Kim Min-Ju works with her unnamed colleague.



Kim Min-Ju behind the camera. "I started to picture myself in the film industry when I was in my second year at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy," says Kim.



Mr. Tame says farewell to his 17th wave students.

News from Old Family

Interview with Mr. Tame

From this semester, students of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy will miss an English teacher—a tall English teacher with blonde hair, thick glasses, and indescribable hair. Mr. Tame, who has taught at KMLA for the past two years, left Korea in the fall of 2013. And months after his rather abrupt departure, *Minjok Herald* interviewed Mr. Tame about his post-KMLA life.

Minjok Herald: *How are you? We hope you are well.*
Mr. Tame: I am fine, thank you for asking. I hope you guys are all doing well too. I know how busy you get, so make sure you also have time for fun. But not too much.

MH: *When did you leave Korea?*
Mr. Tame: Around early September, I guess? I'm back in London—I came back to study literature. This makes me sound like a geek.

MH: *Has London changed much since you left?*
Mr. Tame: Yes and no. The first change I noticed was the skyline—there are a number of new skyscrapers in the city which I get a nice view of whilst studying in the university library. Some of the new buildings are quite impressive, so any budding architects among KMLA students should definitely pay a visit—to London, that is, not me; I do not have the space!
The headlines in the newspapers are much the same as when I left three years ago, which is a little depressing. Journalists in the UK really know how to flog a dead horse. It is amazing what you learn about your own country after spending some time away.

MH: *What do you like about living in London? How is the food?*
Mr. Tame: The best thing about living in London is the easy access to art and culture. And, if you know where to look, it is all quite cheap! I am very excited about eating British food again and being able to buy English tea without ordering it from the internet! The food here is nowhere near as bad as people like to say. Anyway, because there is such a mix of culture here, you can eat anything you want. I do miss *samgyeop-sal* though.

MH: *Then, after being a teacher for a couple years, what is it like to be—or to become—a student again? Which do you prefer?*
Mr. Tame: I know it is a bit of a cliché, but anyone who is, or aspires to be a good teacher should always remain a student. I sometimes get into teacher mode when talking in seminars, so being a teacher is a hard habit to break and I get afraid of seeming big-headed. On the other hand, I did get into trouble once with the professor for not being serious enough and being a class clown. It all balances out in the end.

MH: *Is there a particular reason for leaving before finishing this year? Would it not have been better if you saw your students through 2013?*
Mr. Tame: Of course, having done a job like this, you get to know people—students and teachers—and build good relationships with them. I met 18th wavers in their freshmen year, and I really want to see them through. I'm going to regret this for a long time. But my purpose of leaving is to study, and the British semester is quite different from Korea's—it starts around September. It is hard to see this year through and start a new semester in London.

MH: *What about KMLA life do you miss the most?*
Mr. Tame: I miss working with the group of talented and kind young people that make up the KMLA student body. There were also a number of really good people that I had the pleasure of working with. And of course, I miss my good friends in the English department. And I miss Mr. Garrioch and I taking turns in testing Mr. Tweedie's patience by playing metal and dirge rock on the drive to and from work. Good times!

MH: *You have finally become a "former" KMLA teacher. If your English friend asks about our school, how would you describe it?*
Mr. Tame: Well, I would tell them that it is a good school, for sure. But I think I would tell them most about the students—how much fun they were, and—god—how well they behaved… Oh, and I would also talk about the mountains.

MH: *This could be a silly question, but what do you plan to do with your hanbok? Will you wear it occasionally?*
Mr. Tame: Well, I will not be wearing it in the streets for sure—people in London care much about fashion. Maybe I could wear them while hanging out in Chinatown. But I will sure keep it, though not all of them, like a memento.

MH: *If you could give a short farewell message to each wave?*
Mr. Tame: Sure. But this is going to be tough—I have so much to say to you guys.
16th: Thank you very much for the great experience. Enjoy wherever you're going next, and try to be fearless. Be ready for the big decisions, like the one that I'm facing right now.
17th: You guys are the first wave that I have watched since your freshmen years. Sorry, sorry, sorry for leaving. I really mean it. Always keep those big decisions in mind. By the way, thanks for the fan club.
18th: I hope you have a great time here, I really do. Make the most of it—you guys are so lucky to be here. You've got loads of opportunities that most high school students do not. Help each other out, and I hope I have given you a good impression.
To all of you, don't ever let life catch you sleeping.

Han Ji-Won
Junior Writer, 18th Wave

FREEDOM @KMLA



Each Monday morning assembly adds another intervention
to the already rule-bound KMLA life.
So does every *honjeong*.
As such limits seep into KMLA life, students are beginning
to feel the gradual decrease of freedom to their skin—
and they are wondering why it is happening.

Minjok Herald has captured this phenomenon for you.
Through the following articles, we will be listening
to many different voices, different thoughts on what students think is happening,
and what should be done in response.
After our observations, we are inclined to think **trust** is at the crux of it all—
the reciprocity between students and the school.

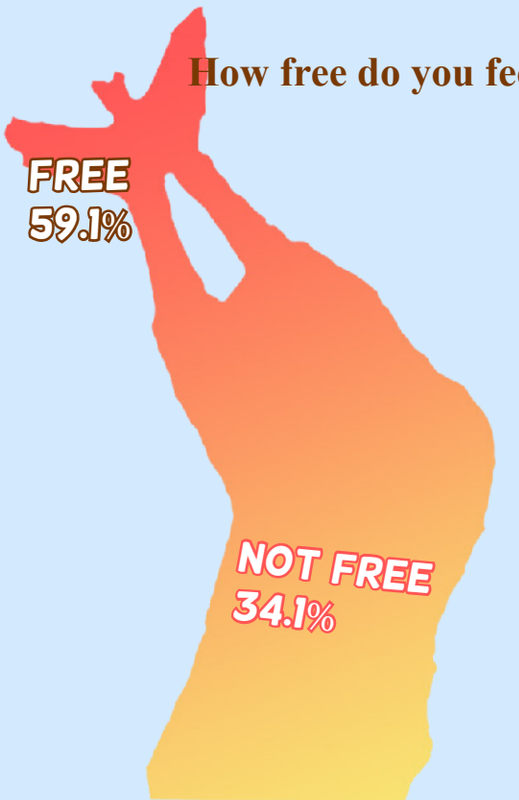
We wonder if you agree.

Cho Woo-Hyun
Junior Feature Writer, 18th Wave

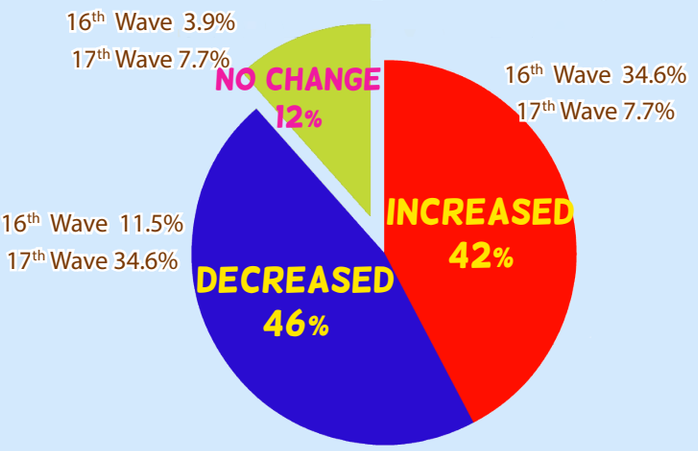
Freedom in Numbers

Data collected through online survey in KMLA Online. June 3-5, 2013
44 responses collected in total (13, 12, and 19 from each wave)

How free do you feel in KMLA?



How did the degree of freedom change, compared to last year?



What are some factors that infringe your freedom in KMLA?

- School regulations 22
- Assignments 16
- Academic studies 14
- Relationships with members of Other waves 13
- Health 8
- Relationships with teachers 7
- Relationships with members of the same wave 6
- Club activities 6

(Number of responses, multiple answers allowed)

What are some factors that restrict freedom in club activities?

- 26 Limited time for club activities
- 11 Relationships with seniors/juniors with different values
- 7 Relationships with friends with different values
- 7 Lack of diversity in clubs
- 5 Limited number of clubs one can sign up for
- 2 Parental intervention
- 2 None
- 1 Other

(Number of responses, multiple answers allowed)

Before entering KMLA, how much freedom did you expect to have?

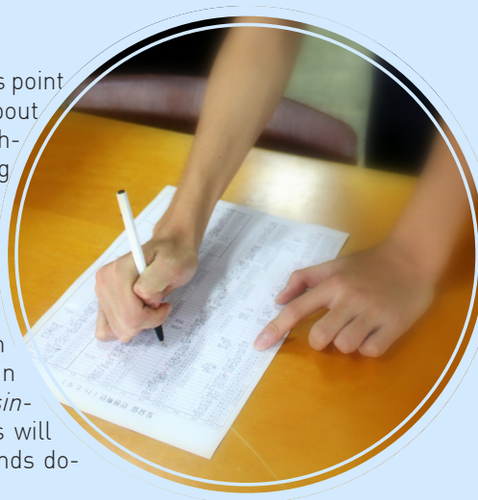
Answered on a scale to 1 (absolute freedom) to 7 (absolutely no freedom)



Survey and data analysis
Hwang Hye-Jung
Staff Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Mornings and Nights under Surveillance

Why We Might Need Morning *Sinseong* and Night Curfew



With rights come responsibility. When the school comes to the conclusion that students are not capable of handling a certain freedom, it applies rules for the sake of safety and stability. The same thing works for curfew violation and *sinseong*; on the same note, these regulations are becoming more restrictive as violations of these rules occur more frequently. Ever since weekend *sinseong* was introduced, it has been a source of misery—failure to wake up in the morning after a tired week will end in two penalty points. Curfew regulations have been a source of another controversy. They had been dealt extensivey by the 16th Judicial Council. Students are split between those who support these regulations as necessary in a dorm life and others who think them obtrusive.

18th waver Koo Ja-Seung stated, "I think curfew is necessary for KMLA students. Frankly, one can always finish whatever they are doing before midnight." As for *sinseong*, 18th waver Roh Hye-Sung said, "Although it is tiresome to go to the 12th floor every morning when I want to sleep, there is no reason to really go against it; it is only that it is a little troublesome." On the other hand, some students have more criticism than compliments. Sul Yu-Bin, an 18th waver, mentioned, "I do not get why we should be forced to go every morning on weekends. Lunch attendance seems legitimate, to prevent absence without leave, but morning sleep is too hard a sacrifice."

Although students argue for the "rights" of their KMLA life, dorm parents agree being early birds is important for the young. Many students agreed on this point after being questioned about school life in KMLA without these regulations. Jung Hyun-Ji, a 18th waver, stated, "If there were no curfew regulation, there would be too many students walking and talking in the hallway. Such activity may worsen problems of student dating. In addition, if there were no *sinseong*, most of the students will probably spend their weekends doing nothing but sleeping."

At first glance, the policy may seem like a heavy and unwanted regulation on their own time. However, order and a sense of responsibility are crucial in a dormitory school. To fulfill these two factors is why such rules have appeared. Perhaps we should try to understand before we complain.

Ha Su-Min
Junior Feature Writer, 18th Wave



From left to right: photos of school culbs SOS, KMLA Kendo club, Minjok Orchestra, and Rhyme Factory

Respect is All it Takes

Students Voice Dissatisfaction over Restrictions on Club Activities

In Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, "self-study" periods are meant to be "self studying" time and that only. The school maintains the narrow definition of studying, where only strict schoolwork is allowed. Students, however, need weekdays for their club activities—and this conflict of perspective has led the school to clamp down on student club activities during self-study as a whole.

Ahn Tae-Hyung, a 17th wave student, gave his thoughts on the restrictions that the school has imposed on club activities. "Although studying is very important for all KMLA students, the school is restricting the club activity time too much. We have to eat lunch and dinner, and during the day we have to go to school. When can we possibly do club activities? Using the weekends can be a possible solution. However, many students go to competitions during weekends, even on the first, third, and fifth weeks. It is especially difficult for the bigger clubs with many members. There just simply is not enough time or an efficient alternative solution."

On a principle level, this restriction seems to contradict freedom for students to manage their own schedule. KMLA gives a great deal of academic freedom to its students. Students do not have an "enforced studying time" as opposed to many other dormitory schools. They are given a chance to manage time on their own, a major strength of our educational policies. Considering the importance of club activities and what it means to the students, many students believe that this policy should be reconsidered. Most of them are against the policy, as they deem the policy as contradictory to the educational goals of the school.

The perspective of the school on this issue is that the students have the weekends to do plenty of club activities. Mr. Kwak No-Jae, the Manager of the Office of Extra Curricular Activities, said, "Our school promotes club activities. But the school believes the very first priority of any KMLA student must be studying. Important though club activities are, we do not want club activities to get in the way of academic studies." The school has repeatedly announced that self-study periods are meant for self-study only, and that weekends can provide more flexibility in the activities that the students do. The school will maintain a strong stance on this issue as long as it needs to.

There are over 100 different clubs that cover almost everything from sports to academics in KMLA. These KMLA clubs have been very successful in the past, and have been honored with numerous awards from competitions at the regional, national, and international level. KMLA takes pride in the astounding number and achievements of the clubs, acknowledging their part in forming a fruitful and independent student body. Many students call for reconsideration of regulating club activities. Though these calls have been around for a while, we have yet to see the school move in favor of the students.

Yang Jae-Ho
Staff Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Tighter Restrictions on Sosa Visits

An Issue of Trust and Responsibility



"Sosa visits on the final days of examinations, prohibited." "Sosa visit on first, third, fifth weekends, additional restrictions*' The restrictions keep on increasing.

Hoengseong Service Station (a.k.a. "Sosa" among students), located near Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, has been used by numerous students in KMLA as a means to relieve stress and, so to speak, as a connection to civilization. Abrupt imposition of regulations left the student body mystified, if not provoked.

In fact, there was no such regulation in the last semester after the midterm examinations were over, at least before numerous students crossed the line. About a hundred students violated outdoor regulations by going to places beyond Sosa—Wonju was the most common, with some finding themselves in Seoul as well. After investigation through CCTVs, the culprits were caught, and regulations ensued.

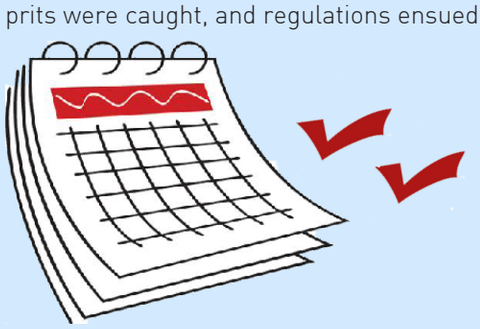
During an interview with the *Minjok Herald*, the Director of the Division of Student Affairs, Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, said weekend regulations were meant to increase time for student activities with school. He added student behavior in the past had contributed to their establishment as well. Regarding the first regulation, he said there was no choice but to restrict postexam visits as the students misused this conventional regulation made for students' own comfort.

"This first regulation may be temporary," he added. "The school would be willing to consider restoring that convention under the condition that students deserve that trust and actively suggest alternatives to the school."

Compromise will not come without effort. While the school is responsible for effective communication and open ears, the mentioned restrictions clearly show that students need to act accordingly to maintain their given freedom in the present, and the future. After all, this whole issue of freedom and regulation—in other words, of trust and responsibility, burdens every student to protect his or her own freedom.

Je Gyung-Hyun
Junior Feature Writer, 18th Wave

*See "From the Inside" of this issue for additional information.



Two Signatures a Day

Another Attendance Check on Top of *Sinseong* and *Honjeong*

It is a typical Saturday afternoon, after the schoolwide writing contest. At least it seems so, until one sets his or her eyes onto a second crowd—the first being the people getting their food—lining up on a table at the front of the cafeteria. A teacher sits watching the people sign their names on the paper on the table. The scene seems similar to that of *sinseong*, but a single, quick glance at the window tells that the time is just past noon. Two signatures lie side by side on the paper. Korean Minjok Leadersihp Academy now has three attendance checks during weekends: *sinseong* in the morning, *honjeong* in the nighttime, and a third one around lunchtime.

Students complain about how this "en bloc" head count—mandating students to come to the twelfth floor between noon and 1 p.m.—infringes on their freedom to live according to their desires. For instance, even someone who would dearly appreciate a long Sunday afternoon nap has to rise from slumber to write his or her name, in order to avoid going to the student court. In an interview with a 17th waver, J, who wished to remain anonymous, expressed her furor on how she would be going to court just because she had no appetite and wished to stay in her room for the whole afternoon: "I was in the worst mood and had a ton of things to do; I did not want to go up or eat so I stayed in my room, when all of a sudden the realization that there is an afternoon attendance check hit. Unfortunately, it was already past 1 p.m. I was miserable." There were many others who had forgotten the existence of an afternoon head count like J.

What brought about this additional attendance check? *Minjok Herald* visited Mr. Kim Dae-Gi, the dorm parent. When asked, he said "I assume that its cause can be attributed to the new outing regulation, which prohibits leaving school on the first, third and fifth weekends of each month." He went on to explain that because the school is responsible for the students' whereabouts and safety, a supplementary attendance check is certainly an attractive option even if it may have its loopholes and side effects.

Of course, students may simply feel that their freedom is encroached on by the new attendance check. Yet the school does not exist to merely intrude upon our lives; students should not react simplistically with anger. The signature policy is a way for the school to keep an eye on everyone's safety. In the students' point of view, there is but one school. On the opposite side, the school has over 400 students to take care of. Some students, however, still are dissatisfied about this "offence" to their freedom: a logical explanation that the student body can understand would certainly help. To demand this, students must also make an effort on their part by adhering to outdoor regulations and other school rules—not just to avoid penalty points, but to establish trust in the student-school relationship.

Hwang Hye-Jung
Staff Feature Writer, 17th Wave

Building Trust

How Other Schools Do It

So far, we have discussed the relationship between freedom and responsibility in Korean Minjok Leadersihp Academy. In this section, we will examine the level of freedom enjoyed by students of two different schools, so as to gain a better understanding of where KMLA stands. How do these schools view student freedom? How are certain freedoms guaranteed or restricted? What can KMLA learn from these schools?

Seoul International School (SIS), a private school educating returnees and students of foreign nationalities, is not a dormitory school; students are free of the heavy regulations that govern KMLA's dormitory life. In other aspects, SIS seems to have more freedom as well. "Our school administration does trust students to wear appropriate attire to school. We do not have particularly obtrusive restrictions on what we are allowed to wear—whether it be clothes or accessories," explains Sarah, a student of SIS. Compared to SIS, KMLA is stricter in terms of attire. KMLA requires students to wear a designated school uniform, hanbok; additionally, KMLA students cannot wear accessories to school. In SIS, there is no particular regulation against playing computer or cell phone games during school hours; students can order food from the outside relatively freely. "We have a Popeyes right in front of the school," Lauren, another student from SIS says. "Sometimes students order chicken from the place."

In terms of academics and extracurricular activities, KMLA and SIS share more similarities. "We are granted a reasonable amount of choice regarding our academics and extracurriculars under the routines of the school schedule," Sarah says. The answers reveal that certain limitations do exist. When asked, she elaborates: "We are not allowed to go on volunteering activities without an advisor and a consent of the school a few weeks before the schedule," she said, explaining how restrictive SIS can be regarding extracurricular activities. "Every year we have to deal with more rules about what we can and cannot do." The circumstances are relatable; KMLA, too, is becoming more stringent in verifying and regulating extracurricular activities, especially for those that occur outside of school.

King's Academy in Jordan, a coeducational boarding school built and maintained by the monarchy of Jordan, naturally has more in common with KMLA. King's Academy has internet restrictions, similar to how KMLA's internet, though fast, is shut down unilaterally after two a.m. The students also lack freedom in other areas. "Our school does not place adequate trust on its students," says James, a Korean student who attends King's Academy. Always acting under a "worst case scenario" assumption, the administration (Office of Student Life) creates rules directed towards any and every mishap that could happen regarding students. For instance, an attendance policy has been created in order to ensure that people with frequent tardy become punctual, not in order to grant privileges for the well behaved. The attendance policy appears to be quite similar to KMLA's new lunchtime checklist during the weekends.

On the other hand, King's Academy does not have student representatives. "The students got rid of student government because they felt the government could never exercise real power in school," James explains. As KMLA has either *sinseong* or morning exercise in the morning, many students eat breakfast; James recognizes this as a good thing. Many students in King's Academy forgo eating before school. In King's Academy, dormitory parents rarely inspect the rooms of students; however, it also has a sort of *honjeong*, though not on a daily basis, where dormitory parents and students meet to discuss whatever issues come up.

What happens when the school and the students get into a conflict? "When school restricted high school students from using the soccer field during breaks, a lot of students (especially the boys) were upset about this and had hundreds of students sign a petition. This shows that SIS students are very sensitive about protecting their rights and we do a very good job in securing them too," Sarah stated, expounding upon the active measures SIS students take. SIS students also express their opinions through their student council; this method is very similar to the method KMLA students usually adopt. "Students express their ideas through whatever means possible," James explained. He commented on how students are slowly working on changing the school by giving their ideas legitimacy through numbers.

Different schools operate on different educational policies. If there is one thing that holds all these schools together, it is the reciprocity between school and students.

Chang Joon-Hyuk
Staff Feature Writer, 17th Wave





Freedom at KMLA: From the Past, at the Present, and to the Future

Alumni on their High School Experience



Recording student voices on the current state of affairs, one has to wonder about what it was like for students of the past. We hear many rumors, confirmed and unconfirmed, floating around the school as stuffs of legend. *Minjok Herald* dipped into the past to find fascinating facts awaiting us.

The lives of KMLAians during the first years of KMLA were drastically different from the lives of students today. For one thing, the self-study periods had no breaks in between, lasting from seven thirty to twelve. "When we dozed during this period, we had to go inside a bathtub filled with cold water," stated 2nd waver Lee Sung-Ho. Students' freedom was severely restricted in many ways, but they were freer than that of the students today in other aspects. "There was curfew, but it was not strictly enforced." Lee said. "Even the dormitory doors were unlocked at night."

Between then and after the turn of the century, there was a clear shift in policy. "Curfews were enforced very strictly—we could not even think about violating the curfew, as there were CCTVs in every room," stated Ms. Lee Won-Ki, a former Language teacher in KMLA who attended the school from 2002. She also mentioned the dozing violation, according to which students would get caned ten times when caught dozing during classes. However, they were granted a great deal of other freedoms. "We could order food freely," said Ms. Lee. She stated that students could get up at any time they wanted on weekends, as there was no *sinseong*, and that they were free to go to Wonju.

As time passed, student life while they attended KMLA became similar to that of today, according to a 14th waver who did not want to be identified. Minor differences still did exist. "We were sometimes excused of the curfew violation when we were just drinking water," he said.

Now, finally, it is the present: What do KMLAians feel about the freedom they have now? "There seem to be many restrictions, which is only to be understood as KMLA is a boarding school that takes management of students and their health seriously," told 18th waver Lee Jee-Hoon. "KMLA grants students enough freedom to make their lives comfortable," stated 17th waver Hwang Hye-Jung, a member of the 15th Student Council. "However, actions of the students that breach the lines tend to make the school stricter about regulating our freedom." She believes that the amount of freedom students can have declined during the time she attended KMLA.

Then, what would be the desirable direction of change for the freedom of KMLAians? "It will not be easy, but I hope the school grants students freedom over wider aspects," said Lee. "Some important issues seem to be decided almost solely by the school, although students are involved." "I hope the school asks the students more for their opinion. I felt this need with the new outdoor regulations implemented this semester. Surveys, when done, should be used to reflect the opinions of KMLAians," expressed another 18th waver, Kang Hoon. "In the future, I hope that the school provides us with sufficient information... so we can make mature choices and choices that benefit ourselves freedom of information," added Hwang.

At KMLA, which hopes to raise its students as future global leaders of the world, freedom certainly means a lot more than merely being able to move around. However, we must remember that rights come with responsibilities. "I certainly wish that students keep in mind that teachers and our school are not there to restrict our freedom," said Hwang.

Chang Joon-Hyuk
Staff Feature Writer, 17th Wave



A Letter from an Alumnus

The sudden request to write something for the *Minjok Herald* got me thinking: what had changed during my first year at University? There was the change of scenery, for one; speaking another language, living in a foreign country, and eating different (yes, it is pretty bad) food were all part of my first year in the UK. But more than my being in a foreign country, there was a feeling that we the students would view each other as foreigners and thus immediately begin stereotyping each other. This was quite obviously embedded in the very first question I was asked upon stating that I was Korean: "Do you play StarCraft?" Ironically, my answer was no. But this is not going to be a list of stereotypes you will encounter. Rather, this will be a list of things I believe anyone should do in order to be someone who is actually interesting and a valuable addition to any group.

Be interesting to talk to. This does not always have to take the form of your being a good speaker or being humorous. Some of you may be better at English than others. Some of you will have difficulty putting words together. The important thing is to at least have something interesting to say. Sometimes it is as simple as having a proper opinion. A few months ago, the death of Margaret Thatcher, the previous Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, immediately sparked a flood of differing opinions on the "Iron Lady." I did not have extensive knowledge of British history and the only opinion I could provide was one created on economic and very thin political viewpoints. While having dinner, I overheard someone say something along the lines of "My aunt managed to convince my little brother that Margaret Thatcher was actually a decent person!"

To which, curious, I enquired why she was so adamant that such an opinion deserved to be ridiculed to such an extent. The answer disappointed me to no end. Her response was

"You mean you don't think she was a horrible person?"

I did not respond to that; I did not need or want to. Everyone is entitled to an opinion, but sometimes one's opinions can simply make conversations dissipate. If you wish to be someone worth talking to, make sure your words are worth listening to.

It is often said nothing makes you feel more patriotic than going to another country, something I feel is quite obviously true. However, it is important to acknowledge the fact that you are no longer in Korea. A problem that occurs to a great many Koreans (and often, Asians in general) is that they will usually avoid mingling with foreigners and stick to each other. I am one of two of the 13 Korean Oxonians in my year that tend to avoid Korean gatherings in favor of hanging out with my non-Korean friends. For many of you, the time you spend in foreign universities will be the first lengthy period you spend abroad, so you should make the most of it. You should not forget that you are Korean, but at the same time, you should not forget that you are in a foreign country. I have made many interesting friends in the UK, characters that would be difficult to find in Korea. For example, one of my closest friends was homeschooled and as a result, has had much experience in experimental chemistry, a lot of which has to do with explosives. During the vacation, I visited his house for a few days, and I had a great time blowing things up. I am in Korea for about half the year, so I try to make the most of my time outside of it. It was refreshing to interact with those who had lived a completely different life; most of the friends I have in Korea had lived lives that are quite similar to mine.

Many of you will be studying abroad, and even if you do not, you will probably come in contact with foreigners at some point. Do not lose your identity as Koreans, but at the same time, do not make that your only characteristic. If the students at my college are asked who I am, they will come up with many different adjectives to describe me, but I am confident that none of them will begin with "He is Korean."

14th wave
Park Sung-Hyun

Mr. Park Sung-Hyun belongs to the class of 2012. He currently studies PPE—an interdisciplinary major with a mix of philosophy, politics, and economics—at Corpus Christi College of the University of Oxford.

World Class Education, Low Class Facilities

The stormier the semester gets, the more nostalgic we become. Vision Trip is a memorable experience for all of us—I, for one, would give anything to be at the Louvre in Paris or St. Peter's Basilica of the Vatican again. On that note, I beg the 18th wave to remember some other place we were equally fascinated by—perhaps a not-so-magnificent place—Wellington College. Some part of the fascination may be accounted for by the big college campus; but what really held the 18th wavers in silent rapture were the fine facilities of Wellington College: Its well-maintained swimming pools, tidy dormitories and up-to-date science equipment.

Such facilities had reminded 18th wavers of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy back in Korea. Frustration, in all its wily ways, seeped in. KMLA has the finest teachers and the best education system in one of the world's larger economies. But when it comes to the quality of school facilities, KMLA is far from a world-class institution. Three of the eight tennis court nets outdoors are unusable. Nets in all three outdoor volleyball courts have been torn down, even though the volleyball club, *MVP,* regularly uses them in practices. The restroom behind the Minjok Cultural Center is not well maintained at all. 4 out of 9 toilets in the men's room does not flush; those that do do not flush well, resulting in an unpleasant smell all year round, along with hygiene problems. Additionally, the restroom has no clean soap; a single dirty block is all there is. The problems extend to the indoors. The water fountains in the English Department Building, the Choongmoo Hall, and the ninth floor of the dormitory are in bad need of cleaning. Hot water comes out of rusty brown holes; the water is often tainted brown. "I use tap water instead," says Mr. Menard of the English Department. Though the school has replaced the water dispensers in the more conspicuous places, others have yet to be maintained properly. The lecture halls in the fourth and tenth floor of the dormitory have no markers nor erasers for the board; the projector in the fourth floor have not worked for a while, causing clubs to conflict over the projector on the tenth floor, according to clubs like *Ecorum.*

Some may argue that what defines a fine educational institution are its excellent teachers, excellent students—thus, there is no need to envy Wellington College. However, fine school facilities are as important for many reasons. Fine facility is the prerequisite of world-class education. For example, even the best instructor cannot conduct a good science class if he lacks science equipment. Also, fine amenities in school will enable students to fulfill their potential academic interest. The school has the obligation to let students enjoy what they want, and students' wishes will be fulfilled when the school provides good enough infrastructure.

So what can be done to improve KMLA facilities? To start with, the school should do its best within limits. Does the school have enough budget to address these issues? When asked, the Director of the Administrative Office said "The annual budget balances out on the positive. Money can be spent on improving school facilities. For educational facilities, however, the requests must be made formally by techers. Currently, no budget is allocated to rebuilding or expanding existing facilities. The latter will have to wait." When asked about specific problems, like the water fountains in the English Department Building, he said the school had the budget to fix it; this was contradictory to the English teachers' testimony that the school continuously asserted the water quality was fine. The school should follow up on these complaints.

The school cannot take care of all these problems at once. However, better ways to manage such facilities will emerge in the future. "The school is looking at the future," says Dr. Han Man-Wi, Deputy Headmaster for Educational Planning. "As KMLA continues to thrive, the school's alumni will be able to contribute to the administration. The school will be able to secure funds from diverse sources then." The increase in budget in the future can be invested in maintaining KMLA facilities. By then, the school will be less tight in budget on maintaining school facilities.

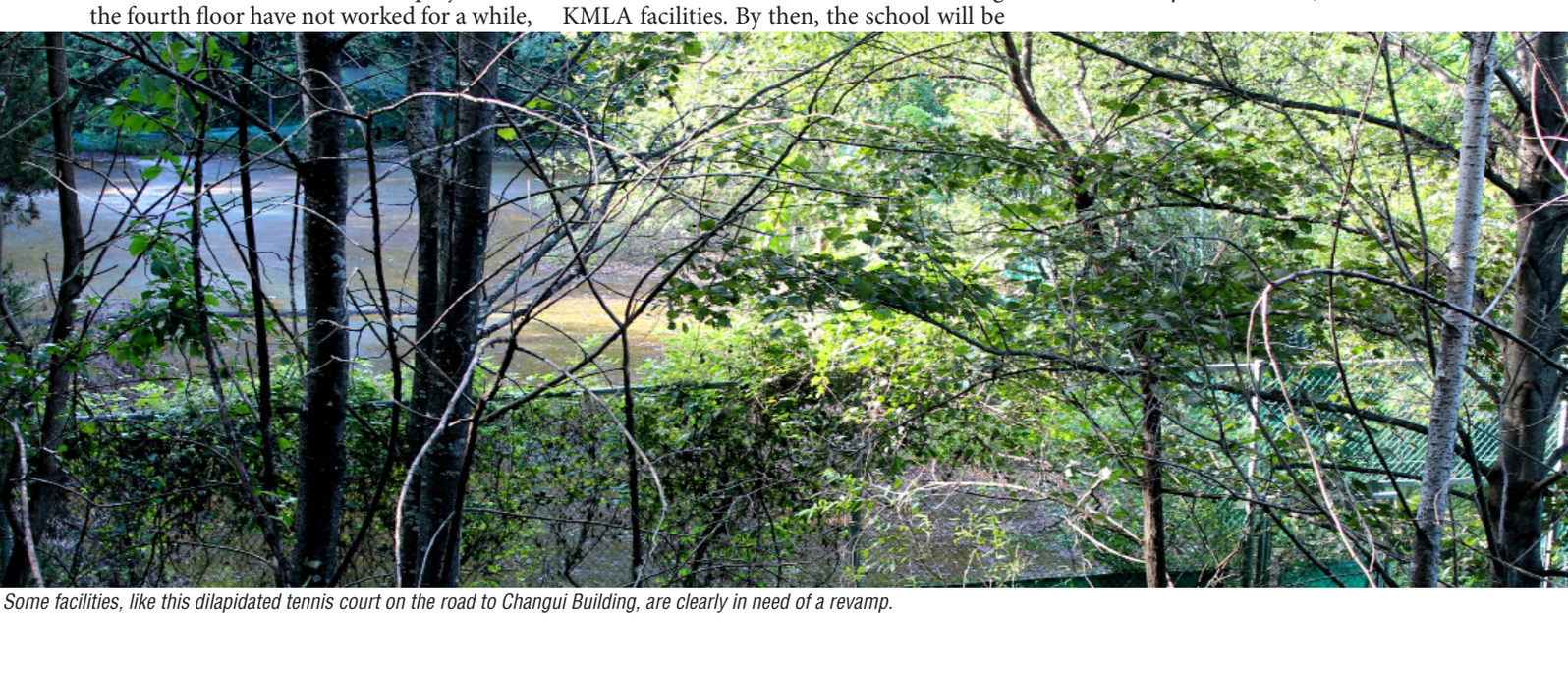
Resolving these issues through spending can only be a limited measure as of now, as the budget is not as free as students would like it to be. The students, therefore, should seek student-oriented solution to this problem whenever possible. The Student Council can designate a student who would regularly manage certain school facilities for a semester. The "manager" of these facilities will be given incentives, such as recording their contributions on the transcript or receiving merit points. Also, the Department of Energy Conservation and Cleaning or certain student clubs could take part in the maintenance of these problematic facilities Students on special training can help the school maintain its facilities as well.

"The school is positive towards student-led changes in the school," says Dr. Han. "However, it is important that the project is based on what both the school and students agree upon. The students should be able to persuade the school that the project will bring positive changes in the school." The school supports solutions brought up by students as long as it is what the school can agree with. If KMLAians come up with such plausible solutions to improve facilities, they would likely bring substantial change.

There are both possible school-oriented and student-oriented solutions. However, in order to bring fundamental changes to the school, it is imperative that students act first about the problem. Students should be concerned about the school problems; we should take the initiative to change how KMLA facilities are managed.

No one else can lead the way to improve the school. It is our job, no one else's.

Hong Ji-Hun
Junior Opinion Writer, 18th wave



Some facilities, like this dilapidated tennis court on the road to Changui Building, are clearly in need of a revamp.

An Accusation to End All Accusations





Here in this public post, proudly behind the mask of anonymity, I would like to call up, discuss, and condemn the reproachable mentality of one KMLAian—yes, just one.

What makes this person culpable? This person is not culpable of one single wrongdoing. Rather, the repeated mistakes and aggressions that have somehow settled down as his or her (let us hold the gender for now) deep-rooted habits have made this accusation inevitable. Just as repeated actions form habits, these habits have in turn been ingrained into the mentality of this person. Sadly, this person has not found the need to correct this faulty mindset. He or she has simply let it ride on a slippery slope.

This KMLAian's mind has unknowingly acquired a permit of some sort—the "license to blame"—and this person has been using it badly. Sometimes online, and at other times offline; sometimes behind the mask of anonymity, at other times with a proud, shameless face, this person is unafraid of blameshifting, insults, and outright rudeness—who?—not anyone else, but another fellow KMLAian.

The list is long, but I could name a few. Just take a look at what this person does at the infamous KMLA Forum. Regardless of the original amount of controversy, almost all of the posts are soon flared up when this person, both with and without anonymity, begin to scribble down thoughtless comments. Sometimes this person mocks the author of the post, sometimes the two find a common enemy. The forum quickly turns into a battlefield, and soon, all that remains is a dirty mess of misunderstandings, prejudices, and slanders —sometimes this mess even ends up at the Division of Student Affairs.

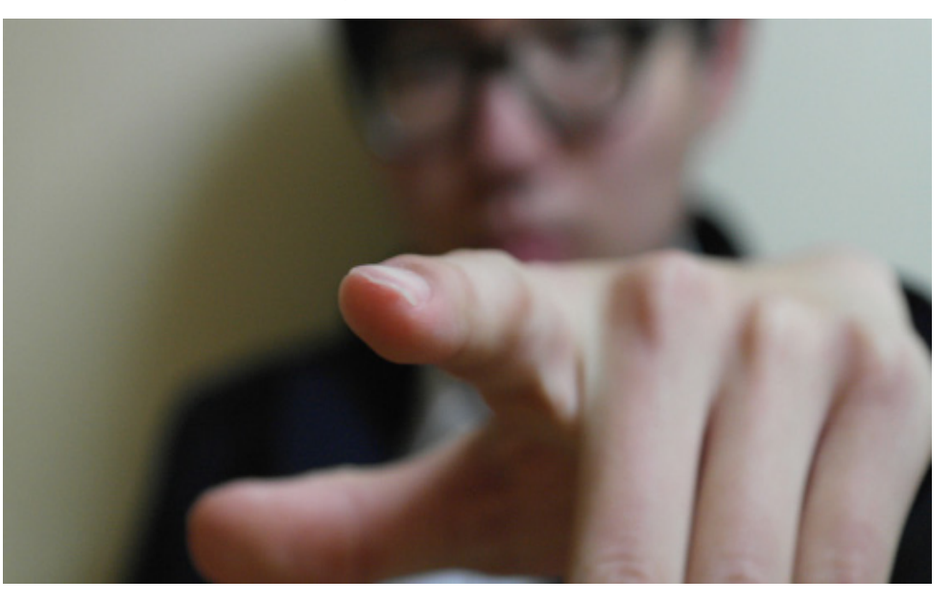
You can also take birthday announcements, nowadays more like birthday attacks, for another. Yes, the secrets one's friends upload on Facebook or KMLA Online under the pretext of congratulations. The culprit says it is to congratulate the person's birthday, but let us face it: the superficial purpose is only secondary. Look at the comments of "mild" or "ordinary" birthday announcements, and all you see are comments made by this person that say "no fun"—another display of mindless verbal assaults, against the author this time. If this person really wanted to congratulate his or her friend, why bother make it "fun," or for the sake of a better word, more "provocative"? The sentiment that dismisses mild congratulations as "no fun" and only cherishes pungent exposures of other's privacy has pervaded this person.

By now, I presume you figured out who this person is. Who is this person? Yes, it is you, the very person reading this post. What? You think you did not post anything controversial on the Forum or write anyone's birthday announcements? Maybe, but I can assure you this: during your life at KMLA, you either talked badly about other people behind their backs, spread vicious unverified rumors that hurt the reputations of others, or simply let all of this happen while making presumptuous judgments by yourself. KMLAians have more and more come to expect less and less from each other—you yourself are one of them, who have been unconsciously breaking apart what was once a family, the KMLA Family.

Then, who am I to accuse you? I am anonymous. Sitting here and typing on the keyboard behind the mask of anonymity, I know that I am doing just what I have been condemning until now. But this time, just this once, this is necessary. This mentality of accusation, of the disunited KMLA falling apart, is on an unstoppable spree, and it can only be extinguished by a wake-up call, a piercing criticism that can make all of us rethink. So here it is—an accusation to end all accusations.

So, let us all stop it now. When criticisms grow into mindless accusations, and when "KMLA Family" turns into an empty phrase, it is time to stop. Please, let us make this post the last one that has to bring others down.

Anonymous



Democracy with Slaves:

Why KMLA Fails to Have a True Student Democracy

The ancient but glorified city of Athens is most prominent for its legacy of building an early democratic society—a system that stood out in its openness and acceptance. But the civilization was actually far from being a "true" democratic society; the majority of the population, as slaves or women, was not represented at all. Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, in terms of its governing system, is almost identical to the ancient city. Claiming to have a successful student democracy, it overlooks the existence of nonparticipant students. Admittedly, these apathetic onlookers have one critical difference from their Athenian counterparts: these pseudo-slaves chose to be slaves.

The fact is clear: student indifference is a grave problem. How many of the students were late for the candidate speeches? How many of us actually listened to the speeches? How many showed up at the press conference for the 16th Student Council? For an event of such importance, there just seems to be too little attention. And the bigger problem is that we, the students, do not even recognize this as a problem.

There already have been too many accounts, articles, and other forms and methods attempting to raise the public awareness concerning the issue. Surely the public was "aware"—it was just that knowing the facts did not lead to action, and even after numerous struggles nobody was willing to change anything. Such substantial problems becoming clichés is nonsensical per se—a portrayal of the shameful state of civic consciousness at KMLA.

So let us put the begging passages aside. Let the already banal arguments be on its own—there have been enough explanation son the necessity of change. The question that matters is why. Why are students so indifferent about student affairs? What causes such prevailing indifference?

The first reason that may come into our minds is lack of time. Of course, all KMLAians are busy. The amount of work required is of a KMLA student is incredible. To participate actively in student government, students would have to split their time by the minute, cramming schoolwork in between. No one can afford to do that, can they? Careful consideration, however, shows such an argument to be an unacceptable excuse. It is true that we barely have enough, or not enough time to do all our work. However, saying there is not enough time is suggesting the idea that the student government's affairs are of less value then their own work is. If one considered participating in student affairs a duty, will students still not have enough time? What of the people who actually do participate?

Then perhaps, the reason is that the student government is ineffective, to the extent where paying any attention to it is absolutely pointless. Again, this reason does not stand. To begin with, the implication that the student government is ineffective is completely false; in fact, the student government has shown some great results. It is easy to forget the achievements of the student government, but simply imagine how KMLA life would be without it—it is not difficult to recognize the necessity and the value of such an organization. In addition, even if the student government was ineffective, should that not be a powerful incentive to pay more attention to it? If your computer, with all your valuable data in it, breaks down, you do not throw it away—you fix it.

This leaves us with one remaining reason: pure selfishness. Putting our personal comfort as a top priority, we ignore the necessity of participation in student affairs. Let us look back at ourselves; remember how we all slept through the long, boring speeches? Remember how we all were unwilling to go to the question-and-answer session? Then compare these moments to how everyone went wild when we saw the candidates dancing—the contrast between the boredom and the excitement is too large. We are only attracted to the things we see as fun or entertaining. We react only to populism and disregard the true policies that our school needs. The root problem, or what is dragging down the quality, the efficiency of the student democracy is this—our tendency to pursue only the things that makes us laugh. This tendency also shows us how underdeveloped our democracy is

These words certainly do not suggest that the student government is perfect. Neither do they imply that everyone should be cursed and be thrown in a lake of fire because we are all so condemnable. The point is that we are no different from the slaves of Athens—slaves of our own indifference, our own egoism. Student democracy cannot function with the majority being indifferent to any matter related to it—and a democracy with slaves, sans voice and contemplation, can never be called as a true democracy. When we choose our path as slaves, with our very own will, we forget the very virtue that is in the name of our school: leadership.



Nature Makes Us Mature

Korea Minjok Leadership Academy proudly presents itself as the torch of knowledge and sacrifice. But it is also a torch of the civilized world in the vast wilderness of Gangwon-do. Since we are isolated from the world by this moat of nature, we must deal with her single-handedly. We came up with the solution of living in truce, trying to ignore the inconveniences she brings. Some students, however, are not content with this way of life. Used to living in cities, they maintain that we keep ourselves "artificial" and detached from nature—but should we?

One of the natural hardships that our school must face is the wildlife. Animals literally swarm the place, running the gamut from flies to wasps, from frogs to snakes, rats to even bats, giving a Chosun-period rustic appearance to the estate. But even more taxing is having to deal with these problems on our own. For instance, one of my friends had a wasp nest hanging on his window for weeks. Of course, he asked the school officials to remove the nest the moment he spotted it, but the help could only come weeks later, after the technicians were fully prepared to deal with wasps. In parallel, we cannot expect help from pesticides or professional exterminators. Students at KMLA are left with no choice but to endure.

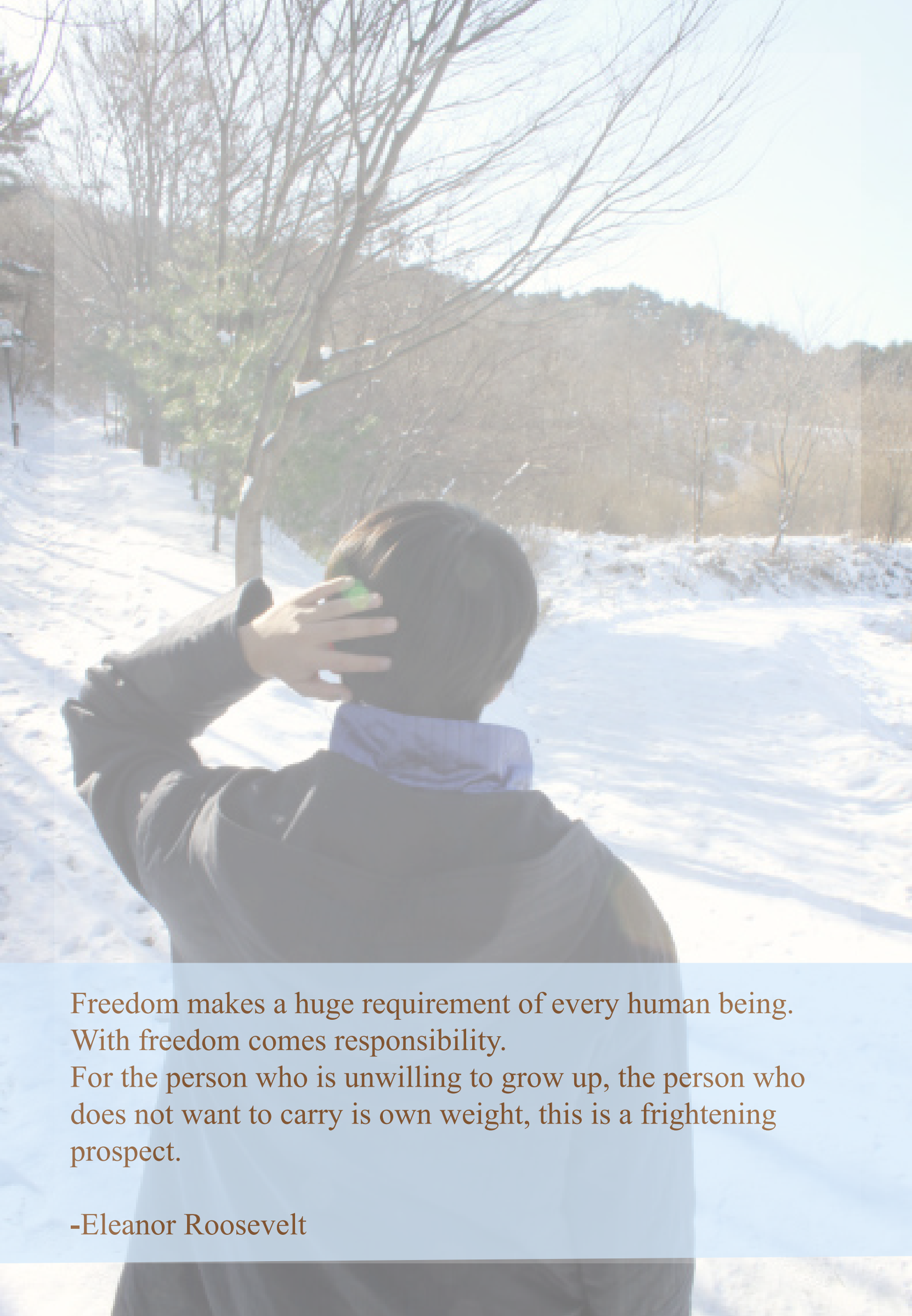
The weather is also a major problem. Most of the school buildings have air conditioning, so changes in temperature are hard to cope with. Thus, students have to rely on their fans to blow away the heat during the summer and curl inside layers of clothes during the winter. Moreover, heavy snowfall causes roads to get chipped off and brick pavements to crumble like crackers, which cannot be dealt with until the snow melts.

This wild environment is not easy to live with, especially for those who have lived all their lives in cities. It is natural for them to long for the many conveniences of modern civilization that effectively cut off all natural factors. They believe that our school must take on the task of urbanizing. Nonetheless, KMLA has a firm stance of its own. We are not necessarily opposed to the improvement of facilities; but when it comes to anything related to nature, we become surprisingly humble. KMLA is a school equipped with the best available Wi-Fi network, yet lacks even a proper air conditioning system. Such ambivalence towards the use of technology has to do with our school's mission of promoting Korea's traditional way of life. Our forefathers have dealt with nature not with force, but with tenderness and humility. Korea has considered nature something to live in harmony with not an annoyance whose only value is the natural resources ready to be exploited, as the enlightened Western societies perceived.

KMLA must have been successful in instilling this sense of humility within the students, because after four months in this school, I have noticed myself adapted to the given conditions. I have learned to walk past wasps indifferently, the winter is not so cold, and the summer heat is not as stifling as before. Overall, the struggles to adapt to the environment of KMLA have turned me from a soft city boy to a patient adolescent—putting forth another step towards our traditional way of life. So, to those not very satisfied with the sudden change in the environment from city to country, try to understand the way of our forefathers, and you will realize how unnatural the urban lifestyle is. Learn to cope with nature, for enduring some inconveniences is an essential part of the KMLA experience.

Kim Jang-Won
Junior Opinion Writer, 18th wave





Freedom makes a huge requirement of every human being.
With freedom comes responsibility.
For the person who is unwilling to grow up, the person who does not want to carry is own weight, this is a frightening prospect.

-Eleanor Roosevelt